Zhian Xu

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Education

UC Berkeley | Class of '29 **Berkeley, CA**
- ➔ *4-year Spieker Program in Business Administration*

Palos Verdes Peninsula High School | Class of '25 **Palos Verdes, CA**
- ➔ GPA: 3.98 (unweighted)

Experience

Palos Verdes Student Advisory Committee **Palos Verdes, CA**
Student Representative of PVPHS *2023-2025*
- ➔ Spoke in board meetings to represent student interests in funding allocations.
- ➔ Advised the superintendent and district office on projects including student health, bond measures, and inclusion initiatives.

National Social Sciences Honors Society **Palos Verdes, CA**
Treasurer and Financier *2023-2025*
- ➔ Recruited over 50+ members and expanded organizational capacity and participation.
- ➔ Organized fundraisers, donation drives and events to manage the club's finances.

Leadership Experience

Peninsula Track and Field **Palos Verdes, CA**
Varsity Competitor, Captain, and Assistant Coach *2021-2025*
- ➔ Competed in D1 Varsity beginning sophomore year, and additionally as captain starting junior year.
- ➔ Organized tournament logistics, planned relay teams, directed workouts, and competed with the best.

Palos Verdes Peninsula Forensics Team **Palos Verdes, CA**
Assistant Coach *2022-2025*
- ➔ Helped tutor middle schoolers and develop their speaking abilities at the Ridgecrest Debate Club.
- ➔ Coached the winner of the 2023-2024 Middle School NSDA National Championships.

Other Experiences: Modernbrain Academy [Teaching Assistant], Peninsula Chess Club [President], and Breaking Down the Walls [Team Leader].

Activities/Projects

Policy Debate **Palos Verdes, CA**
High School Varsity Debater *2021-2025*
- ➔ Four years in Varsity, and was ranked #2 nationally in senior year.
- ➔ Highly developed research skills in areas including economic theory, political science, and scientific development. Competed at 49+ tournaments across 4 years, qualifying for and winning national circuit tournaments at the highest level.

Project SOS **Palos Verdes, CA**
Student Representative of PVPHS 2023-2024
- ➔ Managed and directed a team of 20+ students to create and organize a framework for mental health and inclusion initiatives across the entire Palos Verdes school district.
- ➔ Consulted door-to-door on local concerns while working directly with the school board and superintendent to roll-out funding measures to renovate and improve campus environments.

Other Activities: Mu Alpha Theta (Senior Member), F.C.A. [Senior Member], and Eating Club [Avid Member]

Honors and Awards

Degree of Premier Distinction (One of Ten Nationally) **Remote**
National Debate Coaches Association *3.25*
National Merit Finalist **Evanston, IL**
National Merit Scholarship Federation *4.25*
Other Awards:
Champion: *2025 Southern Bell Forum,* **Semifinalist:** California High School Debate Invitational, AP Scholar with Distinction, and **Qualifier:** 200m CIF Regionals.

Additional

- ➔ **Technical Skills:** Fluent in Chinese, Proficient in Spanish, Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Editing, Cinematography.
- ➔ **Hobbies/Interests:** Stock Investment, Badminton, Poker, Billards, Film, and Chess.